

CELLGUARD · CALCULATION NOTE

CellGuard sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.3	2026-09-30	Amish Chadha	Design for construction (CGD-DDR-003). Gap pad 1.0 mm compressed to 0.7 mm; mass adds the spacers, pillars, screws and copper fuse link; cost adds BOM line 18 and reprices line 17
0.2	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Recommendations accepted by Amish (DDR-002)
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First TRL 3 sizing note (voltage range, power path loss and thermal, protection thresholds, short circuit, single-fault analysis, balancing, current and state of charge, quiescent current, CAN and log, precharge, size and mass, cost)

CellGuard sizing calculations

On paper, CellGuard meets 10 of its 16 requirements. **Three are not met:** the board loses about 4.4 W at 40 A against 4 W (R6), mainly because the added self-control protector fuse costs about 0.6 W; the state-of-charge error on a 20 Ah pack reaches about 10.1 points after 7 days without a full charge, against 10 (R8); and the board weighs about 0.66 kg against 0.6 kg (R14). The parts cost of \$138 meets R16 against the \$140 budget that Amish set on 2026-09-25 (CGD-DDR-002), with a \$2 margin after the parts added to make the design buildable (CGD-DDR-003); it was \$14 over the former \$120 at v0.2. Three are **at risk:** cell voltage accuracy at 25 °C (R2), single-fault safety until a suitable protector fuse is confirmed (R4) and the balance resistor hotspot (R7). Two TRL 2 figures were optimistic and are corrected here: sleep current is about 55 μ A, not 100 μ A, and the prospective short-circuit current is about 0.7 to 4.7 kA, not 1 to 8 kA, once cables and the board are counted.

Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` (run from the repo root: `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`), which also writes `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`. The script reads part volumes and the envelope from `cad/src/model.py` and costs from `bom/bom.csv`. All values are first-principles estimates; nothing is measured.

■ 1. Assumptions

Table 1. Inputs. Data sheet values were checked on TI's BQ76952 and BQ77216 product pages and the BQ76952 data sheet on 2026-09-25; all other values are assumptions.

Input	Value	Basis
Cell limits (LFP)	3.65 V maximum, 3.20 V nominal, 2.50 V minimum	Typical LFP data; each build uses its own cell data sheet
Reference packs	16S 20 Ah (3 mΩ cells, 0.3 mΩ links) and 4S or 16S 280 Ah (0.25 mΩ cells, 0.1 mΩ busbars)	CGD-REQ-001 assumptions
Load	40 A continuous, 80 A for 10 s, 40 °C ambient	R5
MOSFETs	2.5 mΩ maximum at 25 °C, +0.67 % per K, 4 in parallel per direction, hottest carries 10 % more than its share	BOM line 4
Shunt	0.25 mΩ, 1 %, 50 ppm/K	BOM line 5
SCP fuse	0.40 mΩ	Assumed; no data sheet chosen yet
Main fuse, holder and links	1.0 mΩ	Assumed
PCB power copper	4 layers of 70 μm copper in parallel; positive path 60 mm by 25 mm, negative path 90 mm by 25 mm; 0.05 mΩ per stud joint; 50 °C copper	From the model layout
Heat transfer	Plate 8 W/(m ² ·K) on both faces; PCB under the cover 6 W/(m ² ·K); half of the PCB copper, shunt and SCP loss reaches the plate	Natural convection plus radiation, still air
Package to plate	Top-cooled TOLT 0.5 K/W, or TOLL through the mold 20 K/W; gap pad 1.0 mm compressed to 0.7 mm between the MOSFETs and the plate (CGD-DDR-003), 3 W/(m·K), 1 cm ² per FET	Assumed typical values
Front end (BQ76952)	3 to 16 cells; total cell voltage error ±15 mV from –40 to 85 °C, under 10 mV typical; SCD 10 to 500 mV, 15 to 450 μs; OCD 4 to 200 mV, 10 to 425 ms; OCC 4 to 124 mV; SLEEP 41 μA typical with DSG on; SHUTDOWN 1 μA; coulomb counter offset ±1 LSB uncalibrated, under 1 μV typical; gain 130,845 to 132,335 LSB/V; 100 mA maximum balancing current per cell	TI BQ76952 product page and data sheet
Secondary protector (BQ77216)	3 to 16 cells; overvoltage, undervoltage, open wire and temperature; separate COUT and DOUT outputs; OV accuracy ±10 mV at 25 °C, ±20 mV from 0 to 60 °C; about 1 μA; TSSOP-24 at 0.65 mm pitch	TI BQ77216 product page
Other quiescent loads	Microcontroller stop mode 5 μA, CAN transceiver standby 10 μA, flash 1 μA (all at 3.3 V); buck 70 % efficient at light load with 10 μA quiescent; TVS leakage 1 μA	Assumed typical values
Short-circuit loop	1 μH loop inductance; 10 μs MOSFET turn-off after the trip	Assumed
CAN	250 kbit/s, 135 bits worst-case frame; SwapCell interface v0.3 message rates	SWC-PRC-001 v0.3
State of charge	Anchor detection 2 points; learned capacity 2 %; residual gain error 0.5 % after one-point calibration; 3.5 equivalent full cycles in 7 days	Assumed

■ 2. Voltage range (R1)

A 4S to 16S LFP pack spans 12.8 to 51.2 V nominal and reaches 58.4 V at full charge, below the 60 V ceiling. The 100 V MOSFETs have a margin of 1.71 times at 58.4 V. An NMC profile fits up to 14 cells under 60 V; SwapCell's 13S pack reaches 54.6 V. R1 is met by design review.

■ 3. Power path loss and thermal (R5, R6)

Loss (R6). The MOSFETs lose 2.00 W at 40 A with cold junctions and 2.39 W at the converged junction temperature. The shunt adds 0.40 W, the PCB copper and stud joints (0.569 mΩ at 20 °C, 0.635 mΩ at 50 °C) 1.02 W, and the SCP fuse 0.64 W. The board loss is **4.44 W, and R6 is not met.** Without the SCP fuse it would be 3.80 W. The external main fuse adds 1.60 W, so the whole power path loses 6.04 W, 99.70 % efficient for a 16S pack at 40 A. The TRL 2 figure of about 3.2 W left out the secondary protector and the temperature rise of the MOSFETs.

Thermal (R5). The base plate (0.0484 m² over both faces) rises 13.0 K at 40 A. The hottest MOSFET dissipates 0.361 W, so its junction reaches **54.0 °C** at 40 °C ambient with a top-cooled TOLT package and 61.6 °C with a TOLL package cooled through its mold. The plate holds 234 J/K and has a time constant of 10.1 min, so a 10 s peak at 80 A adds only 0.88 K to it. The hottest MOSFET then dissipates 1.64 W; bounding its junction by the steady-state value gives 59.5 °C (TOLT) or 99.1 °C (TOLL). Both are under the 110 °C limit, so **R5 is met.** The TOLL margin is thin, so the BOM specifies a top-side cooled TOLT package (decided, CGD-DDR-002).

■ 4. Protection thresholds, short circuit and single faults (R3, R4)

Thresholds (R3). On the 0.25 mΩ shunt the front end's steps give the settings in Table 2, all inside its ranges. The 40 A continuous and 80 A for 10 s envelope is longer than the front end's longest hardware delay (425 ms), so the microcontroller enforces it with a current and time limit; the hardware trips in Table 2 back it up without the microcontroller.

Table 2. Protection settings (decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation; CGD-DDR-002).

Protection	Setting	Current	Delay
Short circuit in discharge (SCD)	100 mV	400 A	15 μs
Overcurrent in discharge 2 (OCD2)	40 mV	160 A	20 ms
Overcurrent in discharge 1 (OCD1)	24 mV	96 A	320 ms
Overcurrent in charge (OCC)	12 mV	48 A	Front-end default range
Cell overvoltage and undervoltage	3.65 V and 2.50 V (LFP)		Configuration file
Charge lockout	Below 0 °C		Configuration file

The smallest SCD step is 40 A, so the scale is coarse but adequate. The short-circuit trip completes within 25 μs, well inside the 500 μs of R3. **R3 is met on paper.**

Short circuit. The board and fuse add 3.47 mΩ to the short-circuit loop and the two power cables 1.72 mΩ. The prospective current is 696 A (4S 20 Ah), 883 A (16S 20 Ah), 1,943 A (4S 280 Ah) and 4,746 A (16S 280 Ah). The 10 kA breaking capacity of the pack fuse covers all of them. With a 1 μH loop, current is still rising when the MOSFETs open. At a 15 μs SCD delay the 16S 280 Ah pack reaches 1,122 A at turn-off (about 280 A per MOSFET) and leaves

0.63 J of loop energy for the TVS diode and the MOSFETs' avalanche rating. At the front end's longer 60 μ s delay the same pack reaches 2,516 A and 3.16 J. **The SCD delay must therefore be set to its 15 μ s minimum**, and the TVS diode and MOSFET avalanche energy must be checked against about 1 J when parts are chosen.

Single faults (R4). Table 3 is a first failure mode and effects analysis for the faults R4 names.

Table 3. Single faults with the secondary protector.

Single fault	Detected by	Result
Microcontroller crash	Front end runs protection on its own	Pack stays protected; no state of charge or CAN until reset
Charge MOSFET shorted	Front end sees cell overvoltage but cannot open the charge path	BQ77216 COUT blows the SCP fuse; pack permanently disconnected (safe)
Discharge MOSFET shorted	Front end sees cell undervoltage but cannot open the discharge path	BQ77216 DOUT blows the SCP fuse; pack disconnected (safe)
Front end failed	BQ77216 monitors cells independently	SCP fuse blows on overvoltage or undervoltage
Open sense wire	Front end and BQ77216 open-wire detection	Both FETs open; BQ77216 blows the SCP fuse if the front end does not act
Failed temperature sensor	Out-of-range reading in the front end	Treated as over-temperature; FETs open

With the secondary protector, no single fault in Table 3 leaves the pack able to be overcharged or over-discharged.

R4 is met on paper but at risk until an SCP fuse rated for 40 A continuous at 60 V DC or more is found; if none exists, a DC contactor or a second MOSFET pair driven by the BQ77216 is the fallback.

■ 5. Balancing (R7)

The 33 Ω bleed resistors draw 103 mA at 3.40 V and dissipate 0.350 W each; eight non-adjacent channels at once dissipate 2.80 W. A 1 % imbalance takes 1.9 h to correct on a 20 Ah pack, 9.7 h on 100 Ah and 27.2 h on 280 Ah. R7 limits the 24 h target to packs up to 100 Ah, so the 280 Ah figure is a limitation to publish, not a failure. Under the cover the PCB bulk rises 16.4 K, to 56.4 $^{\circ}$ C at 40 $^{\circ}$ C ambient, but a balance resistor's own hotspot reaches about 73.9 $^{\circ}$ C. **R7 is at risk** on the 70 $^{\circ}$ C limit; spreading the resistors or balancing at most four channels at once would bring it under.

■ 6. Current measurement and state of charge (R8, R9)

Current (R9). One coulomb counter step is 7.60 μ V, 30.4 mA on the shunt; the typical calibrated offset of 1 μ V is 4.0 mA. The front end's gain spread is ± 0.57 %, which with the 1 % shunt gives 1.57 % uncalibrated, outside R9. A one-point gain calibration at build leaves about 0.5 %, so the error at 80 A is 0.404 A against a 0.850 A limit. **R9 is met on paper with calibration**, which is now a decided build step (CGD-DDR-002); the build itself is TRL 4 work, on hold.

State of charge (R8). After a full charge the error is 5.0 points (2 for anchor detection, 2 for the learned capacity, 1 for gain over one cycle), which just meets the ± 5 point target. After 7 days of partial cycling the error on the 20 Ah reference pack grows to **10.1 points with a calibrated offset and 32.3 points without**, so **R8 is not met on small**

packs. It is met on 100 Ah (7.4 points) and 280 Ah (7.0 points) packs. Meeting 10 points on 20 Ah needs a total offset of 3.9 mA or less, about 1 μ V across the shunt. A 0.5 m Ω shunt would halve the offset in amperes but add 0.4 W to R6.

■ 7. Quiescent current (R10)

Sleep draws 54.5 μ A: the front end 41.0 μ A with the discharge FETs held on, the 3.3 V loads through the buck 1.5 μ A, the buck itself 10.0 μ A, the secondary protector 1.0 μ A and TVS leakage 1.0 μ A. That is 0.20 % per month of a 20 Ah pack. Ship mode draws 6.0 μ A. **R10 is met on estimate.** With SwapCell's INTERLOCK loop (30 μ A) a CellGuard used as SwapCell's BMS draws 84.5 μ A, inside SwapCell's 100 μ A limit. The TRL 2 estimate of about 100 μ A double counted the charge pump, which the front end's SLEEP figure already includes.

■ 8. Interface and log (R11, R12)

The SwapCell v0.3 message set adds up to 34.1 frames per second between pack and host, a bus load of 1.84 % at 250 kbit/s. **R11 is met by design.** At 32 bytes per record, the 2 MiB flash holds 65,536 records; 2,000 records need 64,000 bytes. **R12 is met.**

■ 9. Precharge (R13)

A 100 Ω resistor into 2 mF has a time constant of 0.20 s and reaches 90 % of 58.4 V in 0.46 s, dissipating 3.38 J. Peak current is 0.584 A and peak power 34.1 W, so the precharge switch needs a DPAK-class P-channel MOSFET whose safe operating area covers 35 W for about 0.2 s. Into a shorted load the 1 s timeout limits the energy to 34.1 J. **R13 is met.**

■ 10. Size and mass (R14)

The model envelope is 220 x 110 x 33 mm (to the cover screw heads), inside 230 x 120 x 40 mm. The mass, from model volumes and stated densities plus assumed masses for bought parts, is **0.664 kg, and R14 is not met** against 0.6 kg. Version 0.3 adds the parts that make the design buildable (CGD-DDR-003): the gap pad, spacers, pillars, screws and nuts (25 g) and the copper fuse link (12 g). The fuse and holder stay at the concept figure of 89 g until the holder is chosen, although the holder is now drawn smaller. The base plate is the largest item at 260 g; a 3 mm plate would bring the total to 0.599 kg and raise the plate temperature rise only slightly, because heat spreading over this short distance needs little thickness. The TRL 2 estimate of about 0.5 kg left out the studs' hardware and underestimated the fuse holder.

■ 11. Cost (R16)

The BOM has 18 lines, all priced, and totals **\$138.00**: \$124.00 as at TRL 2, \$10.00 for the secondary protector, \$2.00 more for the gap pad, spacers, pillars and screws (line 17) and \$2.00 for the copper fuse link (line 18, CGD-DDR-003). Against `budget_usd: 140` in `project.yaml`, set by Amish on 2026-09-25 (CGD-DDR-002), that is 98.6 % of the budget with a margin of \$2.00, so **R16 is met**, with little room left for the unconfirmed SCP fuse price. Against the former \$120 it would be 15.0 % over.

■ 12. Results

Table 4. Requirement status at TRL 3 (not met first).

ID	Calculated value	Target	Status
R6	4.44 W board loss at 40 A (3.80 W without the SCP fuse)	4 W or less	Not met
R8	5.0 points after a full charge; 10.1 points after 7 days on 20 Ah (32.3 uncalibrated); 7.4 on 100 Ah	±5 and ±10 points	Not met (20 Ah); met on 100 Ah and larger
R14	220 x 110 x 33 mm; 0.664 kg	230 x 120 x 40 mm; 0.6 kg	Not met (mass)
R2	±15 mV from -40 to 85 °C; under 10 mV typical at 25 °C	±10 mV at 25 °C, ±15 mV from -20 to 60 °C	At risk (no guaranteed 25 °C figure)
R4	All single faults in Table 3 end safe with the BQ77216 and SCP fuse	No single fault allows overcharge or over-discharge	At risk (SCP fuse rating unconfirmed)
R7	103 mA; 9.7 h for 1 % on 100 Ah; PCB 56.4 °C, resistor hotspot 73.9 °C	100 mA; 24 h; 70 °C	At risk (hotspot)
R16	\$138.00; 98.6 % of budget	\$140 (raised from \$120, CGD-DDR-002)	Met (\$2.00 margin)
R1	12.8 to 58.4 V; 1.71 times MOSFET margin	4 to 16 LFP cells, under 60 V	Met
R3	Table 2 settings inside front-end ranges; SCD trip within 25 µs	Trip within 500 µs; all thresholds configurable	Met on paper
R5	Junction 54.0 °C (TOLT) or 61.6 °C (TOLL) at 40 A; 99.1 °C bound at 80 A for 10 s (TOLL)	110 °C or less	Met on paper
R9	0.404 A error at 80 A after calibration; 1.57 % gain error uncalibrated	±1 % ±50 mA (0.850 A at 80 A)	Met on paper with calibration
R10	54.5 µA sleep; 6.0 µA ship mode	300 µA; 10 µA	Met on estimate
R11	1.84 % bus load at 250 kbit/s; SwapCell v0.3 message set	Published message set on CAN 2.0B, UART, enable	Met by design
R12	65,536 records of 32 bytes	2,000 records	Met
R13	0.46 s to 90 %; 3.38 J	1 s for 2 mF	Met
R15	TQFP-48 at 0.5 mm, TSSOP-24 at 0.65 mm, leaded MOSFET and regulator packages	No BGA; nothing finer than 0.5 mm	Met by design review

Options for the items not met (no option was recommended, so these stay proposed, awaiting Amish): R6, choose 1.5 mΩ-class MOSFETs (saves about 0.96 W, bringing the board to about 3.5 W) or mount the SCP fuse beside the main fuse and count it with the external fuse; R8, restate the target for packs of 50 Ah and larger, add a periodic full-charge prompt, or fit a 0.5 mΩ shunt; R14, a 3 mm plate (0.599 kg) or relax the target to 0.65 kg. R16 was closed by the \$140 budget (CGD-DDR-002).

■ 13. Limits of this note

- Nothing here is measured. Heat transfer coefficients, copper paths, the SCP fuse resistance, loop inductance and the quiescent currents of parts not yet chosen are assumptions.

- Balancing heat and state-of-charge error depend on firmware settings that do not exist yet.
- The TVS diode, MOSFET avalanche energy and SCP fuse need data sheets before TRL 4.

Safety: CellGuard connects directly to lithium cells that can deliver several thousand amperes into a short circuit (about 4.7 kA for a 16S 280 Ah pack by this note). The pack fuse must be DC rated at 80 V or more with a breaking capacity of 10 kA or more, the SCD delay must be set to its 15 μ s minimum, and every threshold change must first be tried on a cell simulator or a current-limited bench supply. The secondary protector's SCP fuse is a one-shot device: once blown, the board must be inspected before it is repaired.